QUICK GUIDE

SAWTOOTH WAVE

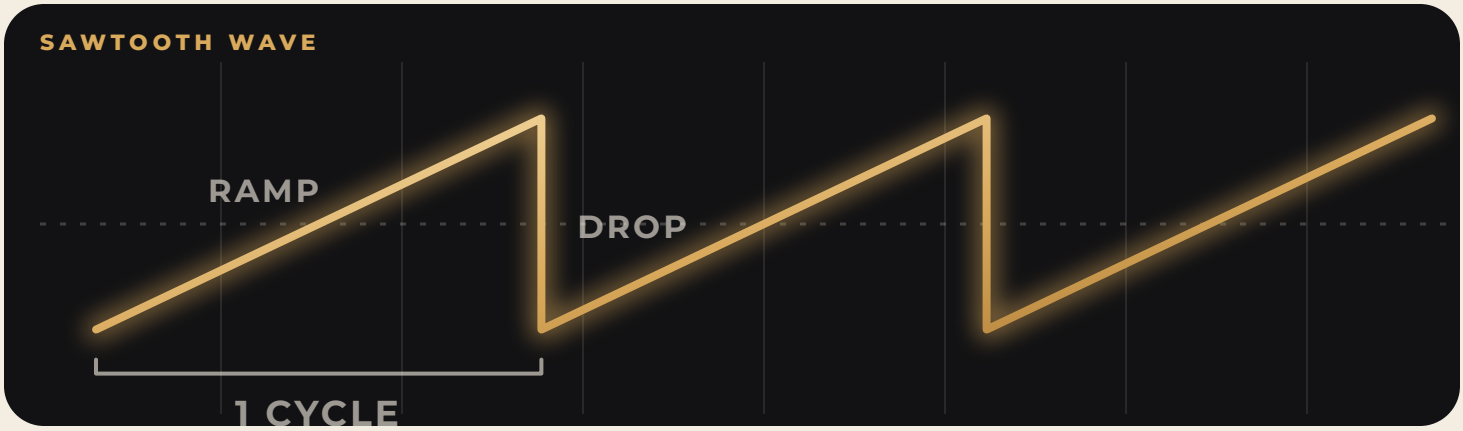
What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

WHAT IT IS

A sawtooth wave rises in a straight line, then drops sharply back to the start. It contains every harmonic, both even and odd.

HOW IT SOUNDS

Bright, thick and buzzy. The classic big synth sound.



01

RAMP AND DROP

Rises in a line, then falls straight down. Like saw teeth.

02

ALL THE HARMONICS

The richest of the basic shapes.

03

BUILT FOR LEADS AND BASS

Big synths, stabs and thick bass lines start here.

DO THIS TONIGHT

Bright, thick sounds need space. Don't stack two on one beat.

- [ ] When a lead or bass sounds thick and bright, think saw.
- [ ] Don't stack two bright sounds on the same beat.
- [ ] Open a filter slowly to bring a saw in.



PRACTICE & CHECK

SAWTOOTH WAVE: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Supersaw leads and big EDM stabs.
- Thick bass lines.
- A great source for filter sweeps, because there's so much for the filter to shape.

QUICK CHECK

1. Which harmonics does a saw wave contain?

2. What does a saw wave look like?

3. Why are saw sounds good for filter sweeps?

Answer key: 1) All of them, even and odd. 2) A ramp that drops sharply. 3) They have lots of harmonics for the filter to shape.

REMEMBER

Ramp up, drop down. Every harmonic. Big and bright.

YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Pulse Wave

